



Parts of the Himalayas are **still rising** at a rate of about $\frac{3}{16}$ in (4 mm) a year



△ **FIRST LIGHT**
At dawn every day, the high snow-clad peaks light up while the valleys remain in darkness.

◁ **FLORAL CARPET**
In July and August, some lower slopes are covered in brightly colored flowers, such as these Himalayan fleeceflowers.

HOW THE HIMALAYAS FORMED

The Himalayas were pushed up by tectonic plate movements that caused India, previously an island, to collide with Asia. In the process, crustal rocks were crumpled and thrust up by as much as 5 miles (8 km).

